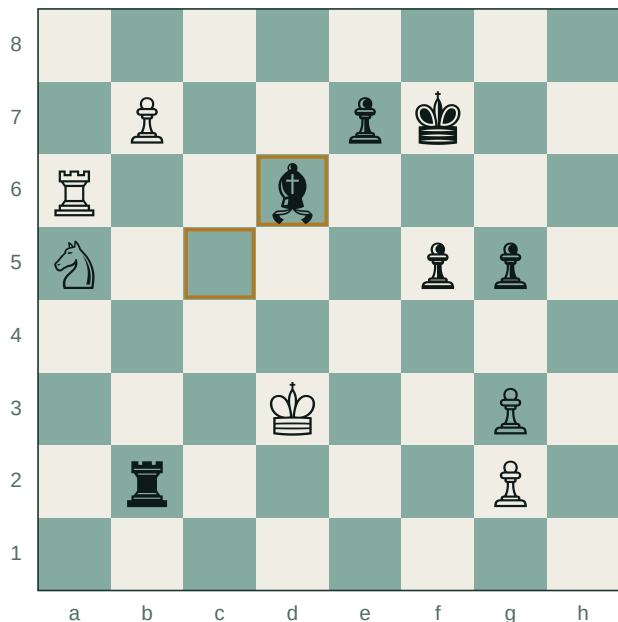


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 41

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 40...Bd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41. Rxd6 exd6 42. Nc6 Rxb7 43. Nd8+ Kf6 44. Nxb7

41.Rxd6 The rook captures the bishop on d6. Recorded reply: **41...exd6**.

42.Nc6 The knight moves from a5 to c6. Recorded reply: **42...Rxb7**.

43.Nd8+ Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. From d8 it attacks king on f7 and rook on b7. Recorded reply: **43...Kf6**.

44.Nxb7 The knight captures the rook on b7.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: rook on b2. Check for tactical protection.